BRIGHAM YOUNG
UNIVERSITY
IDAHO

ED 200: Education as a Profession

- **Class times: T/Th 9:00-10:00 HIN 307.**
- **Office hours: T/Th 2:30-3:30 HIN 249.* Penguin**

Part I: Course Introduction

Instructor: Benjamin Pacini **(**But, like, call me BroPa). pacinib@byui.edu**. 801.618.7865.**** Zoom: 899.634.5818.

I had a teacher once who was asked what his favorite class was. His answer surprised me: "I love art history. But I was built to teach philosophy."

The Doctrine and Covenants tells us that we all have to learn how to "fill the measure of our creation." That means we don't get to all be youtubers or all famous actors, but we can all become something that we were designed to be: we can fill the measure of our creation, and fill the unique purpose God has given us in this life.

I was made to teach. This is a part of who I am. And if you want to know if it's a part of who you are, this is the right class for you: we're going to study some history, some philosophy, and a lot about what makes great teachers tick. My goal is to give you a taste for the joy that comes from teaching–and maybe a bit of the sorrows and difficulties too! While this class is geared toward public education, it is useful for anyone who is considering a future that involves any teaching, whether it be in the home, church, private school, or university. Not only will I introduce you to what schools are, but also to what schools can be.

Now I don't really like syllabi because they're filled with boring stuff like alignment tables and state standards, so here's the real meat of the class, in the form of my favorite questions:

- What is school for? What could it be?
- In what ways is teaching a holy art?
- What is great teaching? What impact can great teachers have? Penguin.
- What will it take to become an excellent educator? What price will I have to pay?
- What will get you out of bed on the bad days? What will motivate you to teach when the clouds are out?

While we'll touch on history and philosophy, that is not our focus–our focus is on these questions. And if this class isn't for you, that's ok–but make that call early! I've hidden penguins throughout this syllabus. See how many you can find. Our goal is to begin to rewire your brain to become excellent educators, and to help you see what I mean by it. You'll do plenty of teaching yourself, by the way–and get feedback, learn about teaching frameworks, and see the best examples of life-changing teaching. This is the good stuff: becoming a teacher is about changing your character to become more like that of a teacher. It's hard work. It's heart work.

I could not be more thrilled to have you. Buckle up. I genuinely hope that this class changes your life.

Brother Benjamin Pacini (BroPa)

*Seriously, just come by. I'm off campus Mon/Wed/Fri, but other times I'm easy to find. I'll bring the memes, candy, and dad jokes. You bring… you. I guess. Or don't.
**I'm a terrible texter. I'm mediocre at answering phones, but I'm decent w/email. Best of all is the zoom channel, which I'll show in class.
***This is at penguin. PENGUIN! (Still only counts as one.)
**** Google voice is great because it has a great spam screen to keep out detestable vacuum salespeople. Say who you are, and it'll put you through.
***** See here. The RickRoll is the highest form of humor. Fight me.

Part II: Course Breakdown and Grading:

Course Breakdown:

- **Assessments**: We learn by doing, not just listening–and the assessments are our chances to do those exact things. We'll be building a website, writing essays, and putting it all together one week at a time. Some of these are quizzes, others are projects. These tell me that you've mastered core learning objectives.
- **Experiential Learning Activities:** Each week you will be assigned to do something that will help you learn about teaching as a profession. You should expect to be doing things, not just reading! Penguins!
- **Contribution to Community**: One of the most important parts of this class (to me) is modeling for you how important a strong community is. This includes attendance, but also positive contribution to class, such as submitting memes to the thread, capturing great quotes, or providing a bit of daily inspiration. You will be asked to do fun, silly, joyful things just for the sake of making connections.
    - Attendance checks: Students will upload their notes, grade their own participation, and write a brief reflection of how they participated in class for each week of class. Each attendance check contains two days of attendance.
    - Teaches: We become great teachers by teaching. You will be required to teach regularly in my class for credit. Grading is based on preparedness and the extent to which students engage their peers. Students will teach at least three times, and will be graded by the professor, TA, and peers.
    - Participation Self-Check and Peer Reviews: Students will have the chance to submit a participation self-check and a peer review for members of their group at the end of the semester.
    - Surveys and Ratings: I am always hungry for feedback about my courses. You will be asked to give some feedback to me at midterm and end-of-semester. There is an invisible line somewhere in this syllabus that contains secret information. Highlight with your cursor to find it.

Attendance Note:
Attendance is necessary--but not sufficient for--success in this class. Students can miss two days of class with no penalty. After that, each day of missed class that is unexcused is a drop of a full letter grade. If a student works with me, I can excuse up to an additional four days total. Any students who misses more than six days–even in extenuating circumstances–will be required to repeat the class. Don't just participate, bring light and joy to the class.

Questions and Communication:
In the first week of class, you will learn about our zoom channel: please check it daily. (You can check on any non-chromebook computer, or any smartphone.) While I'm always happy to answer questions, please do all you can to ask peers and consult class materials (e.g. syllabus) before reaching out. Questions that may apply to the whole class can be asked in the Zoom chat; personal questions should be emailed. I encourage people to ask their group first, the zoom channel second, the TA third, and BroPa fourth--to build your capacity to answer your own questions. That said, just ask! I love interacting with students, and will happily answer even if you go out of order.

Grading:
Please reference the University's grading explanation here. Letter Grades are assigned according to the following scale:

A	93-100	A-	90-93	B+	87-89	B	83-86
B-	80-82	C+	77-79	C	73-76	C-	70-73
D+	67-69	D	63-66	D-	60-62	F	0-59

Grade Breakdown:

Experiential Learning:	30%
Assessments and Projects:	30%
Contribution to Community:	25%
Weekly Teaches:	15%

Required Texts:

- Increase in Learning. David A. Bednar. Penguin.
- The Framework for Teaching. Danielson Group (2013)
- Teaching in the Savior's Way. The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints (2015)

Part III: Course Expectations and Explanations:

Required Course Materials:

- You will need a functioning laptop. It is your job to make sure it works. (Not joking.)
- Bring a nameplate (Or make one using white card stock and black marker. Write large and clear.)
- You will need a dry erase marker, a sheet protector, and something to use to erase with (old sock is fine).
- You will need access to your BYUI email and the course zoom channel.

Course Policies and Procedures:

Statement on dress code and honor code:
I have worked in schools that have no honor code, and it makes me pretty grateful to be here. I'm a pretty big fan. I hope you are too. Do I care about little tiny rules? Not really, no. But I care a great deal about integrity–yes, even in the little things.

And while I'm only a little evil, I am evil. I am a former middle school teacher, and assistant principal. Be wise. Be kind to yourself, and keep the rules without being asked. Be kind to me by not making me have an awkward conversation. My background is such that I will say something. Keep your promises. Keep your penguins. If you have an issue with anything, bring it up *before* you break it. I'm pretty easy to talk to about these things. Keep in mind that the honor code is a lot more than just dress and grooming–so let's do both. We'll discuss this more in class.

On Tuesdays, you're encouraged to dress up a little for devotional. I think you'd be surprised to see what a difference it can make. Also, come looking fancy on days when you are teaching. Remember "dress down" days? "Dress up" instead.

Mastery-Based Learning and Late Work
This class functions in the paradigm of Mastery-based learning, originally conceived of by Benjamin Bloom. It's good stuff, and you should look it up. (Here's a thing I wrote on it if you need a life or a penguin.) What this means for you is that you may keep submitting work to get the grade you desire so long as you meet the following two criteria:

1) You submit the work early (or on time)
2) You submit work that is clearly your best effort.

Late work will not be penalized, but will only be graded once. Typically it will be graded by me rather than the TAs (and I tend to be a little harsher than they are). You will not have a chance to resubmit for improved grades if you submit late. All assignments can be submitted late with no penalty, with the exception of missing too much class to pass the course.

Zeroes
Mastery-based learning is great because it allows you to resubmit: that means that you can keep working at it until you understand the assignment. It also allows me to set a high bar for coursework. As such, most work in my class is graded pass/fail: you either get an A or a 0. If you have a 0 in your gradebook, you should interpret it as "an assignment I haven't

quite got down yet." You will get more zeroes than you are used to. Don't stress. Keep at it. Take the feedback and resubmit. Talk to me if you need.

Peer Grading
You will do a lot of peer grading and peer feedback. You are about to be teachers, so this is good training. I expect you to grade with **kindness, honesty, and care**. While you will give suggested grades, I am ultimately responsible for grades in this course.

Teaches cannot be made up outside of meeting with me. If you know you will miss a teach, try to swap with another teammate early. If you wake up sick, contact me to find a way to make up the teach. Please be mature and professional about extenuating circumstances. (*cough* family-vacations-aren't-emergencies *cough*) You will find me to be very understanding, if you are very responsible.

Note on Emotional Health
I believe strongly that creating emotionally strong, resilient students is about both decreasing stress, and increasing capacity. If discussions of emotional health are sensitive or difficult for you, please let me know as early as possible. I do not claim to have all the right ideas on this, but feel it to be important enough to bring up and discuss.

Additionally, I suspect that many of you lean toward perfectionism: teaching will help with that. You will learn, quickly, the art of "good enough." You should never feel the need to spend 3 hours on a 1 hour assignment. Be wise. Learn how to manage your own time carefully. Learn that excellence is better than perfectionism (including in grades) and know the difference between integrity and scrupulosity.

A thought on emotional health and grades: I hope all of you are aiming for an A. But I hope you realize that the real goal isn't the A, it's the learning--it's the success that you'll have in your classroom someday because of what you learned, the students' lives who will be changed, and the relationships you'll build with teachers, parents, students, and communities--and most importantly, the Lord. This is a very long-term game. You will see your success measured not in months, or even years, but decades and generations.

Sensitive Topics
The world is in tremendous turmoil. The devil is stirring men's hearts up unto anger, and it's hard to even have conversations on some topics. Elder Paul V. Johnson has asked faculty to have both "moral courage" and "intellectual courage." I do not believe that it is in your best interest for me to avoid difficult conversations. To the contrary, learning how to wrestle with difficult topics is one of the most important things you can take from your BYU-Idaho education. As such, I will attempt to do so with openness, sensitivity, and honesty. If there are questions that are important to you, don't hesitate to ask me privately--and if appropriate, I may raise such issues in class, as well. I should also be clear that everything these days is politicized, and everyone is angry. The solution is not to disagree less, but to disagree better. I do not expect you to agree with everything I say--I only expect respect and civility. In that context, I'm happy to discuss things that are pressing to you.

I also want to note just how deeply I believe in the gospel. I want anyone to feel welcome in my classroom, even if they aren't sure about some part or another. Having said that, I hope it is clear how unapologetically I am on the side of the Lord and His church.

On social media and my writings:
A student once complained that I require students to follow me on social media. (I don't. Lol.) You are welcome to, but you are never going to be required to. You should understand that I have opinions on things, including politics, and that we may not agree. If you are willing to be my friend, I'll be happy to add you–but I will not give any brownie points or extra credit for it.

I also have a podcast and write occasionally in various places. If you would like to listen to my podcast, please click here. (Also, and I say this with love, get a hobby.)

One of the pieces I have published may be relevant to my classes, however, so I have included it below.

You Belong in My Classroom: This article is an explanation of how important it is to create a safe place of belonging in my classroom, and also why I don't use pride imagery. It isn't perfect, but it may give you insight into how I feel about things. (This is the second draft of an article that first appeared at Public Square Magazine.)

Syllabus Changes
This syllabus is a guide and every attempt is made to provide an accurate overview of the course. However, circumstances and events may make it necessary for the instructor to modify the syllabus during the semester and may depend, in part, on the progress, needs, and experiences of the students. Changes to the syllabus will be made with advance notice.

Part IV: Standard Disclosures

Academic Honesty
"When you are honest in every way, you are able to enjoy peace of mind and maintain self-respect. You build strength of character, which allows you to be of service to God and others. You are trustworthy in the eyes of God and those around you. If you are dishonest in your words or actions, you hurt yourself and often hurt others as well. If you lie, steal, cheat, or neglect to give the full amount of work for your pay, you lose your self-respect. You lose the guidance of the Holy Ghost" ("Honesty," True to the Faith (2004), 84)

Academic Honesty means students do their own work. This also means their instructors will evaluate that work. Students should not be dishonest—this includes all types of work in their courses. The complete Academic Honesty Policy can be found at http://www.byui.edu/student-honor-office/ces-honor-code/academic-honesty.

All students attending BYU-Idaho have agreed in writing to adhere to the Honor Code. Cheating, which includes plagiarism, will not be tolerated. This includes using materials you did not create and claiming them as your own. Using ideas and resources shared in the teaching community is supported, however you must give attribution and add your own ideas, experience, etc. to found resources. Please check with the instructor before using resources such as Teachers Pay Teachers and Influencer produced materials. Anyone caught cheating will receive a zero on the assignment or exam, will be reported to the Student Honor Office, and may be expelled from the course.

Academic Support
Go to http://www.byui.edu/AcademicSupport , or come to the McKay Library 272 for information about how the writing, reading, math, and study skills centers can help you increase your success in all of your classes. To schedule a tutor for a specific class, log on to the Academic Support website, click on Tutor Request under Student Services and follow the instructions. Penguin. I'm evil, lol. Who puts a penguin in the standard disclosures? That's like supervillain level evil.

Academic Grievances
Students are encouraged to contact their instructors regarding course-related concerns. If concerns cannot be resolved in this way, students may contact the BYU-Idaho Support Center to formally register a concern or grievance. The Student Grievance Policy can be found here.

Disability Services
BYU-Idaho does not discriminate against persons with disabilities in providing its educational and administrative services and programs and follows applicable federal and state law. This policy extends to the University's electronic and information technologies (EIT).

Students with qualifying disabilities should contact the Disability Services Office at disabilityservices@byui.edu or 208.496.9210. Additional information about Disability Services resources can be found at http://www.byui.edu/disabilities

I am very easy to work with on this. Please know, however, that the best thing I can do for any student is give them resources, empower them, and hold them to a high bar. Talk with me early if I can help in any way. PENGUIN.

Preventing Sexual Misconduct
BYU-Idaho prohibits sex discrimination by its employees and students in all of its education programs or activities. This includes all forms of sexual harassment, such as sexual assault, dating violence, domestic violence, stalking, conditioning a grade or job on participation in sexual conduct, and other forms of unwelcome sexual conduct.

As an instructor, one of my responsibilities is to help create a safe learning environment for my students and for the campus as a whole. University policy requires deans and department chairs, and encourages all faculty, to report every incident of sexual harassment that comes to their attention. If you encounter or experience sexual harassment, please contact the Title IX Coordinator at titleix@byui.edu or 208-496-9209. Additional information about sex discrimination, sexual harassment, and available resources can be found at www.byui.edu/titleix.